



Pest-proof plants: rabbits and deer

Deer and rabbits have an appetite for garden plants, crops, and trees and can be a menace in gardens in the countryside or close to parks and open spaces.

Both rabbits and deer tend to nibble on anything that we find tasty or ornamental. One way to keep them at bay is to install barriers. To keep out rabbits, you will need a chicken wire fence that is at least 3ft (1m) high and buried 3in (7cm) in the ground to prevent them from digging under it. Wire mesh fences 8ft (2.5m) tall are required to keep deer out, or plant a tall hedge around your garden using a pest-proof plant, such as boxleaf honeysuckle or forsythia. If it is not feasible to erect fences, opt for plants, such as Griffith's spurge and others described here, which these pests find unpalatable.



SHRUB LARGE

Aesculus parviflora

BOTTLEBRUSH BUCKEYE Best suited to large gardens, this deciduous shrub has palm-shaped leaves and bears spires of fluffy white flowers from mid- to late summer. It has a suckering habit and spreads to form a large clump of stems.

↑10ft (3m) ↔15ft (5m)

☀️ ⚠️ 🌱 Z4–8 (N)



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Artemisia ludoviciana 'Silver Queen'

WESTERN MUGWORT This clump-forming perennial is grown for its slender, aromatic silvery gray leaves on upright stems, and small yellow flowers in summer that are best removed. Can spread aggressively.

↑↔30in (75cm)

☀️ ⚠️ 🌱 Z4–9 (N)



PERENNIAL LARGE

Achillea filipendulina

YARROW This perennial forms a clump of finely cut, aromatic gray-green leaves and large, flat-topped, bright yellow flower heads on sturdy stems in summer. The flowers can be cut and dried. 'Gold Plate' (above) is a tall variety.

↑4ft (1.2m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀️ 🌱 Z3–8



PERENNIAL LARGE

Aconitum napellus

MONKSHOOD This upright perennial has deeply divided dark green foliage and tall spires of indigo-blue blooms from mid- to late summer. Best planted in a shady site; it needs additional support. All parts are toxic if ingested; handle it with gloves.

↑5ft (1.5m) ↔12in (30cm)

☀️ ⚠️ 🌱 Z3–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Asplenium scolopendrium

HART'S-TONGUE FERN This clump-forming evergreen fern has long, tapering, tough, glossy green fronds, which are replenished in late spring. Plant beneath trees and taller shrubs, or as ground cover in shady beds. Remove damaged leaves in spring.

↑30in (75cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀️ 🌱 Z5–9 (N)



SHRUB LARGE

Cotinus coggygria

SMOKE TREE Grown for its colorful leaves, this shrub develops fiery fall tints and plumes of smokelike summer flowers. 'Royal Purple' (above) has rich purple leaves and flower plumes. Plant it near a bed as a deer-deterrent screen.

↑↔15ft (5m)

☀️ 🌱 Z5–8



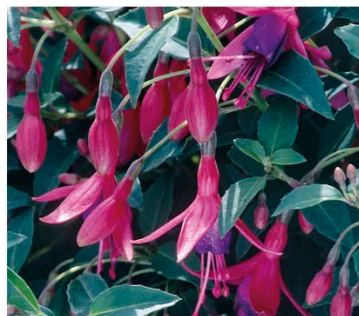
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Euphorbia griffithii

GRIFFITH'S SPURGE A bushy perennial with red stems of narrow, copper-tinged dark green leaves topped with clusters of orange-red flowers in early summer. Suited to larger beds, it spreads fast. Animals find the toxic milky sap unpalatable.

↑30in (75cm) ↔20in (50cm)

☀️ ⚠️ 🌱 Z4–9



SHRUB SMALL

Fuchsia 'Tom Thumb'

FUCHSIA Suitable for beds and containers, this dwarf variety has oval dark green leaves, and flowers from summer to fall, bearing red and mauve bell-shaped blooms. If attacked by deer or rabbits in spring or summer, the plant recovers soon.

↑↔20in (50cm)

☀️ 🌱 Z9–11



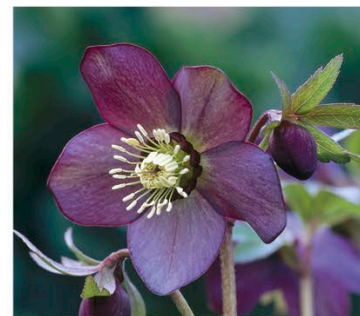
PERENNIAL SMALL

Geranium sanguineum

BLOODY CRANESBILL This spreading perennial forms a neat mound of deeply dissected dark green leaves and bears magenta-pink single flowers in summer. Tolerant of sun or shade, it can be planted in many positions in the garden.

↑10in (25cm) ↔12in (30cm) or more

☀️ 🌱 Z4–8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Helleborus x hybridus

LENTEN ROSE With dense divided foliage, this clump-forming evergreen perennial bears nodding, cup-shaped white, pink, or purple flowers from winter to early spring. Plants hybridize readily and are highly variable. Self-seeds if not deadheaded.

↑↔24in (60cm)

☀️ ⚠️ 🌱 Z4–9